UX RESEARCH · PROJECT 1

Empathy map and user personas

A fitness app for busy office professionals

Prepared by MOKSHI KUMARI
DecodeLabs UI/UX Design Internship · Batch 2026

TARGET AUDIENCE

Office professionals aged 25 to 45 who spend 8 to 10 hours a day at a desk, commute daily, and want to stay active but struggle with time, energy and consistency.

- Desk-based work
- Daily commute
- Low energy by evening
- Quit apps early

AW AHMED WASI

26 · Junior software engineer

Sits at a screen nine hours a day and orders dinner after late deadlines. Wants to feel fitter but treats exercise as something for later.

GOALS

- Have energy that lasts the workday
- Lose a few kilos without a gym schedule
- Build a routine that survives busy weeks

FRUSTRATIONS

- Workouts feel too long to even start
- Quit three fitness apps within weeks
- Feels judged in crowded gyms

"I'll start on Monday. Every week."

RF RIDA FATIMA

34 · Marketing manager, parent of two

Juggles campaigns, school runs and family dinners. Her own health is always the last item on the list.

GOALS

- Fit movement into small gaps in the day
- Reduce stress and sleep better
- Set a healthy example for her kids

FRUSTRATIONS

- No predictable free hour
- Plans collapse when work or family changes
- Feels guilty when she skips a session

"If it takes more than ten minutes, it won't happen."

AV Amit Verma

41 · Remote sales executive

Works irregular hours from a home desk. Back stiffness and a stalled routine have made him skeptical of fitness promises.

GOALS

- Ease back and neck stiffness
- Move regularly despite no fixed schedule
- See visible progress to stay motivated

FRUSTRATIONS

- Generic plans ignore his age and limits
- Motivation fades without feedback
- Too many apps, no clear guidance

"I don't need more apps. I need one that fits my day."

Method: [add how you gathered insights, e.g. 5 interviews, app-store review analysis]

EMPATHY MAP · PRIMARY PERSONA

AHMED WASI, 26

Junior software engineer

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Sees
What surrounds him each day

- Coworkers leaving for lunch workouts
- Fitness reels on Instagram
- An unused gym card in his wallet
- A calendar packed with meetings

Thinks
What goes on in his head

- I'll start from Monday
- I don't have a full hour
- Am I too out of shape to begin?
- Fitness apps are all the same

Feels
His emotional state

- Guilty about skipping workouts
- Drained after a long workday
- Stressed by constant deadlines
- Motivated in bursts, then flat

Does
What he actually does

- Skips the gym after long days
- Orders food late at night
- Downloads apps, quits within a week
- Stays at his desk through lunch

Pains
Fears and obstacles

- No time for hour-long workouts
- Routines that feel repetitive
- Fear of being judged at the gym

Gains
What success looks like

- More energy through the workday
- Short workouts he can stick to
- Visible progress that keeps him going

Key insights

Time, not motivation, is the barrier

He wants to be fit but cannot find a reliable block of time.

Opportunity: sessions that fit any gap.

Past app failures breed skepticism

Generic plans and streak pressure lead to quitting within weeks.

Opportunity: flexible plans that forgive missed days.

Small wins build the habit

Short sessions between meetings feel doable and show quick progress.

Opportunity: ten-minute workouts with visible progress.

EMPATHY MAP · SECONDARY PERSONA

RIDA FATIMA, 34

Marketing manager, parent of two

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Sees
What surrounds her each day

- School pickup times blocking her calendar
- Colleagues posting morning run photos
- Laundry piling up and dinner to plan
- Fitness app notifications she never opens

Thinks
What goes on in her head

- I'll do it once the kids are asleep
- Ten minutes is not worth changing for
- Everyone else manages this better
- My health can wait until things calm down

Feels
Her emotional state

- Guilty when she skips her own health
- Stretched thin between work and home
- Exhausted by nine at night
- Proud on the days she does move

Does
What she actually does

- Takes calls while cooking dinner
- Skips workouts when plans change
- Walks only on school runs
- Starts a plan Monday, drops it by Thursday

Pains
Fears and obstacles

- No predictable free hour
- Plans collapse when family needs her
- Guilt over time spent on herself

Gains
What success looks like

- Movement that fits small gaps
- Less stress and better sleep
- A healthy example for her kids

Key insights

Her schedule is unpredictable, not empty

Free time exists in fragments, rarely in a planned hour.

Opportunity: plans that adapt to her day.

Guilt is part of the loop

A missed session feels like personal failure, which leads to quitting.

Opportunity: no-shame resets after a skipped day.

Family context shapes everything

Routines that respect family time are easier to keep.

Opportunity: short routines she can do at home.

EMPATHY MAP · SECONDARY PERSONA

AV

Amit Verma, 41

Remote sales executive

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Sees
What surrounds him each day

- A home desk used all day
- Fitness ads promising fast results
- Old running shoes by the door
- Stiffness every time he stands up

Thinks
What goes on in his head

- Plans like this never fit my schedule
- I'm too old to start from scratch
- Will this ever show real results?
- Too many apps, which one is right?

Feels
His emotional state

- Skeptical of fitness promises
- Stiff and low on energy
- Frustrated by stalled progress
- Hopeful when he sees results

Does
What he actually does

- Works irregular hours without breaks
- Tries a new app every few months
- Stretches only when it hurts
- Quits when progress feels invisible

Pains
Fears and obstacles

- Plans that ignore his age and limits
- Motivation fading without feedback
- Too many apps, no clear guidance

Gains
What success looks like

- Less back and neck stiffness
- Regular movement without a fixed schedule
- Clear, visible progress

Key insights

Skepticism comes from past letdowns
Earlier apps overpromised and ignored his physical limits.

Opportunity: honest, personalized starting points.

Progress must be visible
Without feedback he loses motivation within weeks.

Opportunity: simple milestones and progress tracking.

Irregular hours need flexibility
A fixed daily time does not work for a variable remote day.

Opportunity: on-demand sessions with no fixed slots.